AppealDesk

Your Homeowner Savings Guide

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Property Tax Exemptions & Credits You May Qualify For

Based on your property in Suffolk County, New York, we have identified the following property tax exemption and credit programs that may apply to you. Each program listed below includes eligibility requirements, estimated savings, and instructions for how to apply. *Since we do not collect personal information such as age or veteran status, each program below is listed as "If you qualify..." so you can identify which programs may apply to your household.*

STAR Exemption (School Tax Relief)

Reduces the school tax burden for owner-occupied primary residences. Basic STAR exempts the first $30,000 of your home's assessed value from school taxes. New applicants since 2015 receive the STAR Credit (check) instead.

Estimated Savings: $300-$800/year

Eligibility: Must own and occupy the property as your primary residence. Combined household income must not exceed $500,000.
Deadline: March 1 for new applicants (STAR Credit application)
Form: Register for STAR Credit online or Form RP-425
Apply: https://www.tax.ny.gov/star/
If you bought your home after 2015, you receive the STAR Credit as a check instead of an exemption on your tax bill. Register at tax.ny.gov/star. Existing STAR exemption recipients do not need to re-register.

Enhanced STAR Exemption

Increased STAR exemption for senior homeowners. Exempts a larger portion of your home's assessed value from school taxes than Basic STAR.

Estimated Savings: $600-$1,600/year

Eligibility: Must be 65 or older. Combined income of all owners and their spouses must not exceed $98,700 (adjusted annually).
Income Limit: $98,700 (adjusted annually)
Deadline: March 1 for new applicants; annual income verification required
Form: RP-425-E (Enhanced STAR Application)
Apply: https://www.tax.ny.gov/star/
The Enhanced STAR savings can be up to twice the Basic STAR amount. You must enroll in the Income Verification Program or provide income documentation annually.

Veterans Exemptions (Alternative, Cold War, Eligible Funds)

Multiple veteran exemptions available depending on your municipality. The Alternative Veterans Exemption provides 15% of assessed value for wartime service, plus additional percentages for combat zone and disability.

Estimated Savings: $500-$3,000+/year depending on disability and local adoption

Eligibility: Must be a veteran who served during a qualifying period. The specific exemptions available depend on which exemptions your municipality has adopted.
Deadline: March 1 (or as set by your local assessor)
Form: RP-458-a (Alternative), RP-458-b (Cold War)
Apply: https://www.tax.ny.gov/pit/property/exemption/vetexempt.htm
New York has several different veteran exemption types, and each municipality chooses which to adopt. Contact your local assessor to find out which veteran exemptions are available in your community.

Persons with Disabilities and Limited Incomes Exemption
Sliding-scale exemption of 5% to 50% of assessed value for persons with disabilities and limited incomes.

Estimated Savings: $200-$2,000/year depending on income and local rates

Eligibility: Must have a qualifying disability (physical or mental impairment that substantially limits major life activities). Income limits set by the local municipality, typically $37,400 or less.
Income Limit: Varies by municipality (typically $37,400 or less)
Deadline: March 1
Form: RP-459-c
Apply: https://www.tax.ny.gov/pit/property/exemption/disabledprsn.htm
The exemption percentage depends on your income level. Both the income limits and the exemption percentages are set by your local municipality. Must reapply annually.

Gold Star Parent Exemption
Property tax exemption for parents of children who died while serving in the U.S. armed forces.

Estimated Savings: Varies by municipality

Eligibility: Must be the parent of a child who died in military service. Must own and occupy the property.
Deadline: March 1
Form: RP-458
Apply: https://www.tax.ny.gov/pit/property/exemption/vetexempt.htm
Surviving spouses of veterans may qualify for the veterans exemptions listed above.

Assessment Cap/Freeze
New York does not have a statewide assessment cap. Some municipalities may have local limits on assessment increases. Enhanced STAR provides effective school tax relief for qualifying seniors.

Senior Citizens Exemption (Municipal)
Sliding-scale exemption of 5% to 50% of assessed value for seniors with limited income. This is separate from Enhanced STAR and can be combined with it.

Estimated Savings: $200-$3,000+/year

Eligibility: Must be 65 or older with income below the limit set by your municipality (typically $37,400 or less). Must own and occupy the property.

SCHE (Senior Citizen Rent Increase Exemption) / DHE (Disability Rent Increase Exemption)
For rent-regulated tenants in NYC. Freezes rent for qualifying seniors (62+) and disabled persons.

Estimated Savings: Protects against future rent increases

Eligibility: Must live in rent-regulated housing in NYC with combined annual household income of $50,000 or less.

Source: https://www.tax.ny.gov/pit/property/exemption/index.htm
These programs are independent of your property assessment. You can apply for exemptions regardless of whether you file a property tax appeal. Even if your assessment is accurate, you may be overpaying taxes simply because you have not applied for exemptions you qualify for.
Exemption programs and eligibility requirements change periodically. The information above is current as of 2026-03. Verify current requirements with your county assessor's office before applying.

Reassessment Protection Guide

Understanding what triggers a reassessment of your property can help you protect your current assessed value and avoid unexpected tax increases.

Actions That May Trigger Reassessment

- **Building permits:** Pulling a permit for renovations, additions, or structural changes will typically notify the assessor of improvements to your property.
- **Major visible renovations:** Exterior improvements such as new roofing, siding, additions, or added structures (pools, garages, ADUs) may prompt a reassessment even without a permit.
- **Listing on MLS:** Listing your home for sale, even temporarily, can expose a higher market value to the assessor, especially if the listing price significantly exceeds your current assessed value.
- **Refinance appraisals:** In some jurisdictions, a high appraisal obtained during refinancing can become part of the public record and influence your assessment.
- **Insurance rebuild valuations:** Replacement cost estimates from insurance claims can signal a higher property value.
- **Adding structures:** Pools, accessory dwelling units (ADUs), detached garages, and other permanent structures increase your property's value.

How to Protect Your Current Assessment

- **Document your home's current condition:** Take dated photos showing any deferred maintenance, needed repairs, or functional issues. This documentation can support a lower valuation if challenged.
- **Keep records of needed repairs:** Maintain a list of deferred maintenance items (aging HVAC, roof wear, plumbing issues). These reduce your home's value relative to comparable properties.
- **Understand your reassessment schedule:** Know when your county's next reassessment year is so you are not caught off guard by changes.
- **Review your annual assessment notice:** When you receive your notice of assessed value, compare it to the prior year and to recent comparable sales in your neighborhood.

Your state's reassessment cycle: New York reassesses property on a annual basis. Understanding this cycle helps you anticipate when your assessment might change.

What to Do If Your Assessment Increases

If your assessed value increases significantly, you have the right to grieve. The key steps are:

- Review your grievance deadline (see the Appeal Window section of this packet)
- Gather comparable sales data showing your home's actual market value
- Document any property-specific factors that reduce value (condition issues, location drawbacks, functional obsolescence)
- File your grievance before the deadline

AppealDesk can generate a comprehensive evidence packet if your assessment rises in the future. Visit https://www.appealdesk.com to get started.

Understanding Your Property Tax Bill

Your property tax bill includes more than just the base property tax. Understanding each component helps you identify which charges can be challenged and where potential savings exist.

How Your Tax Is Calculated

The core formula is: **Assessed Value x Tax Rate = Base Property Tax**. Your total bill then adds special district assessments, voter-approved bonds, and various fees on top of this base amount.

Common Line Items You May See

- **School district levy:** Typically the largest portion (often 40-50% of total). Funds local public schools and sometimes community colleges.
- **County general fund:** Covers county services including roads, courts, public safety, and administration.
- **City/municipal tax:** Funds city services such as police, fire, parks, and infrastructure. Only applies if you live within city limits.
- **Fire/emergency services district:** Funds local fire protection and emergency medical services. Common in unincorporated areas.
- **Library district:** Funds local library operations and programs.
- **Stormwater/drainage fees:** Based on impervious surface area. Some jurisdictions bill these separately from the tax bill.
- **Voter-approved bonds:** Debt service on bonds approved by voters for schools, infrastructure, parks, or other public projects.
- **Solid waste assessment:** Some jurisdictions include trash collection fees on the property tax bill.
- **Special improvement districts:** Charges for lighting, sidewalks, or other neighborhood-level improvements.

Which Charges Can Be Challenged?

Challengeable **Ad valorem (value-based) taxes:** The core property tax based on your assessed value. This is what a property tax appeal addresses. Reducing your assessed value reduces this portion of your bill proportionally.

Separate Process **Special assessments and fees:** Flat-rate charges for specific services (stormwater, solid waste, special districts) often have their own dispute process. Contact your county for details.

Not Challengeable **Voter-approved bonds:** Bond levies approved at the ballot box generally cannot be individually challenged through the appeal process.

Where Your Tax Dollars Typically Go

While the exact breakdown varies by jurisdiction, a typical distribution of property tax revenue is:

~45%	~25%	~15%	~15%
Schools	County Services	City/Municipal	Special Districts

These are national averages. Your jurisdiction's breakdown may differ. Check your tax bill or county website for the exact distribution.

Energy Savings & Rebate Finder

Beyond property tax savings, significant financial incentives are available for home energy improvements. Many homeowners are unaware of these programs, which can save hundreds to thousands of dollars per year on energy costs.

Federal Programs (Available Nationwide)

Energy Efficient Home Improvement Credit (25C)
Tax credit of up to $3,200/year for qualifying home energy improvements including insulation, exterior doors, windows, central air conditioners, heat pumps, water heaters, and electrical panel upgrades.

Up to $3,200/year ($1,200 general limit + $2,000 for heat pumps/heat pump water heaters)

Eligibility: Available to all homeowners for improvements to their primary residence. Must meet ENERGY STAR or other efficiency standards.
How to claim: Claim on your federal tax return using IRS Form 5695. Keep receipts and manufacturer certification statements.
Available through: Through December 31, 2032
Details: https://www.energystar.gov/about/federal_tax_credits/tax_credits_702

Residential Clean Energy Credit (25D)
30% tax credit on the cost of solar panels, solar water heaters, battery storage, geothermal heat pumps, fuel cells, and small wind turbines.

30% of total system cost (no maximum limit)

Eligibility: Available to homeowners for installations on any home they own (primary or secondary). Must be a new installation, not previously used.
How to claim: Claim on your federal tax return using IRS Form 5695. Unused credit can carry forward to future tax years.
Available through: 30% through 2032, then 26% in 2033, 22% in 2034
Details:
https://www.energystar.gov/about/federal_tax_credits/renewable_energy_tax_credits

High-Efficiency Electric Home Rebate Act (HEEHRA)
Point-of-sale rebates for electrification upgrades: up to $8,000 for heat pumps, $1,750 for heat pump water heaters, $840 for electric stoves/dryers, $4,000 for electrical panel upgrades, and $1,600 for insulation.

Up to $14,000 total in rebates per household

Eligibility: Income-qualified: households earning less than 150% of area median income get the largest rebates. Moderate-income households (150-200% AMI) get

50% rebates. Above 200% AMI are not eligible for HEEHRA rebates.
How to claim: Applied as a point-of-sale discount through participating contractors. Check with your state energy office for availability.
Available through: Funds available until September 30, 2031 or until exhausted
Details: https://www.energy.gov/scep/home-energy-rebates-programs

New York Programs

NYSERDA Residential Programs
The NY State Energy Research and Development Authority offers rebates for insulation, air sealing, HVAC, and whole-home performance upgrades.
Details: https://www.nyserda.ny.gov/All-Programs/Residential-Programs
EmPower+ provides free efficiency upgrades for income-eligible households. The Comfort Home program offers rebates for all homeowners.

NY-Sun Solar Incentive Program
Upfront incentives for solar installations ranging from $0.20-$0.40 per watt depending on your utility territory and system size.
Details: https://nyserda.ny.gov/ny-sun
Combines with the federal 30% tax credit for substantial total savings. Additional incentives available for low-to-moderate income households.

NY Solar Property Tax Exemption
Solar, wind, and farm waste energy systems are exempt from property tax increases for 15 years.
Municipalities must opt in. Most NY municipalities have adopted this exemption. Check with your local assessor.

Visit nyserda.ny.gov for comprehensive program listings. Contact your utility (Con Edison, National Grid, NYSEG, RG&E, Central Hudson) for additional rebates.

Where to Start

For maximum savings, energy efficiency experts recommend this order of improvements:

1. **Air sealing and insulation first.** This has the highest return on investment and enables right-sizing of HVAC equipment. Typical savings: 15-30% on heating and cooling costs.
2. **HVAC heat pump upgrade.** Heat pumps provide both heating and cooling, qualify for the largest rebates, and can reduce energy costs by 30-50% compared to traditional systems.
3. **Water heater replacement.** Heat pump water heaters use 60-70% less energy than conventional models and qualify for substantial rebates.

Federal tax credits require filing IRS Form 5695 with your annual tax return. State and utility programs may have different application processes. Program availability and amounts are

subject to change. Consult with a tax professional regarding your specific eligibility.

Property Tax Watch: Continuous Assessment Monitoring

As more comparable sales data becomes available in your area, your case for an appeal may strengthen. Property Tax Watch monitors your assessment year-round and alerts you to changes and new opportunities.

- ✓ **Annual assessment change alerts** delivered to your inbox when your county updates your property value
- ✓ **Automatic overassessment detection** comparing your assessed value against current market data
- ✓ **Filing deadline reminders** so you never miss your window to appeal

Activate Your Free 12-Month Monitoring

https://www.appealdesk.com/tax-watch

Grievance Window & Deadline Summary

In New York, the process for challenging your property assessment is called a "grievance." Here is what you need to know about timing and deadlines for Suffolk County.

Mark Your Calendar
New York Grievance Deadline: Typically March - June
Review Board: Board of Assessment Review
County: Suffolk County, New York

The typical grievance window in New York is **March - June**. During this period, homeowners can file a formal grievance of their assessed property value.

When Your Grievance Window Opens
Your grievance window typically opens when you receive your **Notice of Assessment** from the county. This notice is mailed to property owners, usually in the spring.
Keep this notice. You will need it to file your grievance. It contains your property identification number, current assessed value, and instructions for filing.

New York Grievance Process

If you choose to grieve, the process follows these levels:

1. Assessor (Informal)
2. Board of Assessment Review (Grievance)
3. Small Claims Assessment Review (SCAR)
4. Supreme Court (Article 7)

An **informal review** is available before the formal hearing in most jurisdictions. This is often the fastest path to resolution.

If you need a complete evidence packet to support your grievance, AppealDesk can generate one with comparable sales analysis, a cover letter, and filing instructions tailored to your property. Visit https://www.appealdesk.com to get started.

This guide is for informational purposes. Exemption eligibility and program details should be verified with your county assessor's office before applying. Energy rebate programs are subject to change and funding availability. Consult with a tax professional regarding your specific eligibility for tax credits.